STOWZA · LAUNCH

Launch Cost Breakdown

Every rupee between the build that exists today and Stowza live on Google Play and the App Store.

SETUP, ONE-TIME	RUNNING	FIRST YEAR	TIME TO LIVE
₹18k–47k	**₹2,960/mo**	**₹45k–75k**	**9–12 wks**

26 September 2026. Costed against four decisions you made, listed on the first page — change any of them and §7 says exactly which numbers move. Figures in INR at ₹88 to the dollar. Ranges appear only where a third party sets the price; each one says what decides it and gives a planning number.

1. What this is costed against

Four decisions. Everything downstream follows from these, so they are stated first rather than buried.

PLATFORMS

Both, together

Google Play and the Apple App Store, launched at the same time.

PUBLISHER

A new company

Registered entity, not a personal account. Needs incorporation first.

IOS BUILDS

Cloud CI

macOS build runners. No Mac purchase.

LEGAL PAGES

Template service

Paid policy generator, adapted to the app. No lawyer.

What these choices cost you, versus the cheapest possible path: publishing as a company rather than personally adds incorporation (₹5,000–25,000) and up to 30 days of verification — but it removes Google's closed-testing requirement, which applies to personal accounts. Adding iOS adds ₹8,700 a year and a second review process. Cloud CI instead of buying a Mac saves ₹50,000–1,50,000 up front.

2. One-time setup costs

Paid once, before launch. This is the whole cost of being allowed to publish.

ITEM	INR	REQUIRED	WHAT DECIDES THE NUMBER
Company registration	5,000 – 25,000	YES	Your CA's fee, the structure (proprietorship is cheapest, Pvt Ltd dearest), your state, and authorised capital. **Plan ₹15,000.**
D-U-N-S number	0	YES	Free from Dun & Bradstreet. Both Apple and Google require it for a company account. Takes time, not money.
Google Play registration	2,200	YES	$25, once, for the life of the account. Never renews.
Apple Developer Program	8,700	YES	$99. **Renews every year** — see §4.
Domain	1,000 – 1,500	YES	`.in` is cheaper than `.com`. Needed for the policy pages and as the sender domain for OTP mail.
Privacy policy + terms	1,000 – 10,000	YES	Template service tier. The copy already exists in-app, so this buys defensibility, not writing.
Release signing key (Android)	0	YES	`keytool`, free. Generated by you.
iOS certificates & provisioning	0	YES	Included in the Apple membership.
App icon, screenshots, launch film	0	—	Already built. See §6.
Subtotal — required	**17,900 – 47,400**	**Plan ₹28,000.**	
Trademark filing, one class	4,500	OPTIONAL	Government fee at the individual/startup rate.
Trademark attorney	5,000 – 15,000	OPTIONAL	Only if you file. Does not block launch.
With trademark	**27,400 – 66,900**	**Trademark can wait until the name has proven itself.**	

3. Running costs

Monthly, from the day real users arrive. Most lines start free and stay free through launch; the table says exactly when each one starts charging.

SERVICE	FREE UNTIL	AT LAUNCH	AT SCALE	NOTE
Vercel app, API, site	NEVER — SEE BELOW	1,760	1,760	Pro plan, $20.
Routing fare quotes	Not free for production	1,000	2,100	Self-hosted OSRM on a small VPS.
Upstash Redis OTP store	10k commands/day	100	100	~3,000 sign-ins a day.
Domain renewal	—	100	100	Annual fee, shown monthly.
Email OTP delivery	3,000/mo, 100/day	0	1,760	Charges once you pass 100 new users a day.
Geocoding address search	A few thousand/day	0	4,300	The line most likely to grow fastest.
Crash reporting	5,000 errors/mo	0	2,300	Free tier is plenty unless something is badly wrong.
Cloud macOS CI iOS builds	Free-tier minutes	0	2,500	Only charges if you release often.
Map tiles	Unlimited	0	0	OpenFreeMap, donation-funded.
Push FCM + APNs	Unlimited	0	0	Both are free at any volume.
Monthly		**₹2,960**	**₹14,920**	**Plus payment fees — §5.**

THE ONE LINE PEOPLE MISS

Vercel's free plan does not permit commercial use. That is a licensing rule, not a traffic limit — the moment Stowza charges for a delivery, the free tier stops applying regardless of how little traffic it serves. ₹1,760/month, unavoidable, from day one of taking money.

Why "at scale" is not a prediction. Every line in that column is a documented tier threshold, not a forecast. You move to it when you cross the threshold in column two, and not before.

4. First year, and what changes in year two

	LOW	PLAN	HIGH
One-time setup (§2, required only)	17,900	28,000	47,400
Running costs, 9 months live	26,640	26,640	26,640
First year total	**₹44,540**	**₹54,640**	**₹74,040**

Assumes roughly three months of setup and verification before launch, then nine months live at the launch run rate.

Year two onward

ITEM	ANNUAL
Running costs, 12 months at the launch rate	35,520
Apple Developer Program renewal	8,700
Domain renewal (already inside the monthly figure)	—
Google Play (one-time fee, never renews)	0
Year two	**₹44,220**

Company registration and the legal pages do not recur. The only new annual line is Apple's ₹8,700 membership, which must be paid or the iOS app is removed from sale.

5. Store commissions — and why they do not apply to Stowza

This is the largest number on the page that you will not pay, so it is worth being exact about why.

Apple takes up to 30% and Google up to 30% on **digital goods and services bought inside an app** — subscriptions, in-game currency, premium features. Both offer reduced rates (15%) for smaller developers.

STOWZA SELLS A REAL-WORLD SERVICE, SO STORE BILLING DOES NOT APPLY

Both stores exempt physical goods and real-world services — deliveries, rides, food, tickets — from their in-app purchase requirement. A parcel moved from Bangalore to Mysore is a real-world service. That means Stowza may take payment through UPI or an Indian payment gateway and **pay the stores nothing per transaction.**

What you will pay instead: a payment gateway takes roughly 2% plus GST on that fee, and only when money actually moves. On a ₹79 delivery that is about ₹1.85.

What would change this: selling anything consumed inside the app — a subscription, priority matching, a paid tier — moves that revenue under store billing at 15–30%. If you ever plan a subscription, model it before building it, not after.

Google's fee structure in India also has alternative-billing rules that change the picture for digital goods specifically. They do not affect delivery revenue.

6. Already built, so not in the numbers

Most of what a launch normally costs is done. This is why the total is ₹55,000 and not ₹2 lakh.

ITEM	TYPICAL COST	STATUS
The application	₹2L – ₹15L	Built. 54 screens, four roles, 1.3.1, TypeScript clean, production build clean.
App icon	₹1,000 – 10,000	Done. 20 Android mipmap assets including the adaptive set; iOS icon set present.
Screenshots	₹2,000 – 15,000	Done. Two frames at 1080×1920 from the launch film.
Promotional video	₹10,000 – 50,000	Done. A 24-second launch film with poster frame.
Policy copy	₹5,000 – 30,000	Written, in-app. Needs publishing to a URL, not writing.
Account deletion flow	dev time	Done. In-app path in Settings — the harder half of that requirement.
Android target API 36	dev time	Done. Already meets the requirement that takes effect 31 August 2026.
Release signing config	dev time	Wired into Gradle and verified to build without a key present.
Reviewer access build	dev time	Done. The demo build self-signs in and has its own package id.
Download site	₹5,000 – 25,000	Live, serving both builds.

7. What would change these numbers

Each row says which decision moves which figure, so you can re-price without redoing the analysis.

IF YOU CHANGE…	EFFECT	DETAIL
Drop iOS	–₹8,700/yr	Also removes the Apple review queue, the second set of store assets, and the cloud-CI line. Cuts roughly 2 weeks from the timeline.
Publish personally instead of as a company	–₹5,000 to 25,000	But adds Google's closed-testing requirement: 12 testers opted in for 14 continuous days before you may request production access.
Buy a Mac instead of cloud CI	+₹50,000 – 1,50,000	One-time. Worth it only if you release iOS builds frequently.
Lawyer-reviewed legal instead of template	+₹4,000 – 20,000	Worth considering: the app handles Aadhaar/KYC documents, which is the most sensitive data category in it.
Launch passenger rides too	≈ ₹0 infra	Barely changes cost. It changes how much traffic you need before either side of the marketplace works — a product risk, not a budget one.
Add a subscription or paid tier	15–30% of that revenue	Moves it under store billing. See §5.
Switch OTP from email to SMS	+₹0.15–1 per message	At 10,000 OTPs a month, roughly ₹3,000. The app uses email today, which is why this is ₹0.
GST registration becomes required	Compliance cost	Depends on turnover and supply type, not on publishing. Ask your CA — the threshold, not the app store, decides it.

TWO THINGS TO CONFIRM BEFORE YOU COMMIT THE BUDGET

Exchange rate. Every dollar line is converted at ₹88. Apple and Google bill in USD, so a rate move changes those two lines together.

Foreign-vendor GST. Indian GST on imported digital services is not included above. Add roughly 18% to the Apple, Google and Vercel lines if you need a precise figure for accounting.